A SHIPPER'S RESOURCE

Freight Forwarders and Logistics Providers Import Readiness Checklist

12 things to confirm before you book your next shipment, so the permits, customs treatment and delivery plan are settled early.

Why Late Compliance Costs You in Freight Forwarding

For freight forwarder and logistics provider cargo, the cost is rarely the freight. It is a permit, classification or handling requirement discovered after the goods have already shipped. Typical cargo includes air, sea, courier, project, regulated and recurring client shipments handled on behalf of logistics providers. Mills Permits, Mills Customs and Mills Logistics work together to settle these points before you book.

Use this list before you book. Any box you cannot tick is the item to resolve first.

The Readiness Checklist

- ☐ **1. Your role in the shipment is clear**
  State whether you act as carrier, forwarder, consolidator or agent for each shipment, since responsibilities differ.

- ☐ **2. A licensed broker is coordinating customs**
  Confirm which licensed customs broker will file the entry, and how you will work together.

- ☐ **3. Client authority is documented**
  Keep signed authorization from each client for the actions taken on their behalf, including customs filing.

- ☐ **4. Importer details are verified for each shipment**
  Check the importer's registration and details before documents are prepared, and keep proof on file.

- ☐ **5. Permit responsibilities are defined**
  Agree in writing who obtains any permit, license or clearance the cargo needs, and by when.

- ☐ **6. Classification and valuation duties are assigned**
  Agree who confirms classification and value, and what evidence is kept to support them.

- ☐ **7. Document handling and confidentiality are set**
  Set rules for how client data and documents are stored and shared, including with partners.

- ☐ **8. Consolidation documents are consistent**
  Make sure master and house documents agree on parties, cargo and weights, and match the customs entry.

- ☐ **9. Pre-arrival lodgement is planned**
  Send complete documents to the broker before arrival so the entry is prepared and reviewed.

The Readiness Checklist (continued)

- [ ] **10. Release, storage and delivery are assigned**
  Agree who is responsible for payment, release, storage and delivery, and for charges that accrue.

- [ ] **11. A hold and exception protocol exists**
  Agree how clients are informed if cargo is held, examined or delayed, and who responds to the agency.

- [ ] **12. Records and accountability are maintained**
  Keep complete files for each shipment so you can show what was filed, by whom, and on what authority.

Handling client shipments? Let us check it before it ships.

Book a short call and we will review your product, permits and delivery plan before it moves.

BOOK A CALL

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General guidance only, not legal advice. Requirements vary by product and shipment; confirm with The Mills before booking.